PEW RESEARCH CENTER FOR THE PEOPLE & THE PRESS
June 3-6, 2010 NEWS INTEREST INDEX OMNIBUS SURVEY
FINAL TOPLINE
N=1,002

ASK ALL:

PEW.1 As I read a list of some stories covered by news organizations this past week, please tell me if you happened to follow each news story very closely, fairly closely, not too closely, or not at all closely. First, **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE] [IF NECESSARY** "Did you follow **[ITEM]** very closely, fairly closely, not too closely or not at all closely?"**]**

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	(VOL.) DK/ Refused
a. Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy					
June 3-6, 2010	35	33	16	14	1
May 27-30, 2010	43	29	13	15	*
May 20-23, 2010	40	35	13	11	*
May 13-16, 2010	49	32	11	8	1
May 7-10, 2010	42	34	11	12	*
April 30-May 3, 2010	32	37	17	14	1
April 23-26, 2010	42	31	13	14	*
April 16-19, 2010	40	32	14	14	0
April 9-12, 2010	40	32	15	13	*
April 1-5, 2010	33	34	14	19	*
March 19-22, 2010	41	32	14	13	*
March 12-15, 2010	41	35	12	12	*
March 5-8, 2010	40	34	12	13	*
February 26-March 1, 2010	31	33	17	19	*
February 19-22, 2010	38	34	15	12	*
February 12-15, 2010	35	34	15	16	*
February 5-8, 2010	43	36	13	9	*
January 29-February 1, 2010	45	32	13	10	*
January 22-25, 2010	41	34	14	10	*
January 15-18, 2010	37	38	14	11	*
January 8-11, 2010	39	33	15	12	*
December 18-21, 2009	45	31	14	10	0
December 11-14, 2009	42	31	14	13	*
December 4-7, 2009	41	36	13	9	1
November 13-16, 2009	38	33	14	15	*
October 30-November 2, 2009	34	32	17	16	*
October 23-26, 2009	44	30	15	10	1
October 9-12, 2009	41	29	16	13	*
October 2-5, 2009	44	30	15	11	0
September 25-28, 2009	44	37	10	10	*
September 18-21, 2009	44	34	15	7	*
September 11-14, 2009	45	32	14	9	*
September 3-6, 2009	41	31	15	13	*
August 28-31, 2009	45	30	13	12	1
August 21-24, 2009	50	27	13	10	1
August 14-17, 2009	41	37	11	12	*
August 7-10, 2009	42	34	13	10	*
July 31-August 3, 2009	46	34	11	8	*
July 24-27, 2009	45	35	12	8	*
July 17-20, 2009	43	35	11	11	1
July 10-13, 2009	37	38	13	11	*

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	(VOL.) DK/ Refused
July 2-5, 2009	38	35	15	12	*
June 19-22, 2009	42	33	15	10	*
June 12-15, 2009	41	35	12	12	*
June 5-8, 2009	41	34	11	14	*
May 29-June 1, 2009	43	37	11	8	*
May 21-24, 2009	44	35	13	9	*
May 15-18, 2009	44	35	12	8	*
May 8-11, 2009	42	34	12	12	*
May 1-4, 2009	47	36	11	5	1
April 17-20, 2009	52	30	10	7	1
April 9-13, 2009	48	29	13	10	0
March 27-30, 2009	48	32	10	10	*
March 20-23, 2009	52	34	8	6	*
March 13-16, 2009	48	33	9	10	*
February 27-March 2, 2009	56	30	8	6	*
February 13-16, 2009	55	29	10	6	*
January 30-February 2, 2009	52	31	12	5	*
January 23-26, 2009	57	30	8	5	0
January 16-19, 2009	43	35	13	9	*
January 2-4, 2009	42	36	15	7	*
December 12-15, 2008	51	33	9	7	*
December 5-8, 2008	42	38	13	7	*
November 21-24, 2008	59	24	9	8	*
November 14-17, 2008	56	29	9	6	*
November 7-10, 2008	54	31	8	7	*
October 31-November 3, 2008	63	27	6	4	*
October 24-27, 2008	52	35	7	5	1
October 17-20, 2008	62	29	6	3	*
October 10-13, 2008	65	25	7	3	*
October 3-6, 2008	69	23	5	3	*
September 26-29, 2008	70	22	5	3	*
September 19-22, 2008	56	27	12	5	*
September 5-8, 2008	44	33	16	7	*
August 29-31, 2008	41	34	13	11	1
August 15-18, 2008	39	36	15	10	*
August 8-11, 2008	39	35	16	10	*
August 1-4, 2008	47	34	11	8	0
July 25-28, 2008	46	32	10	12	*
July 18-21, 2008	45	33	13	9	*
July 11-14, 2008	44	33	12	10	1
June 27-30, 2008	49	31	12	7	1
June 13-16, 2008	42	33	14	11	*
May 9-12, 2008	45	31	13	11	*
May 2-5, 2008	43	31	15	10	1
April 18-21, 2008	41	35	13	10	1
April 4-7, 2008	39	37	12	12	*
March 28-31, 2008	42	36	14	8	*
March 20-24, 2008	45	33	13	9	*
February 29-March 3, 2008	38	35	15	11	1
February 15-18, 2008	37	36	11	16	8
February 1-4, 2008	40	37	14	8	1
January 18-21, 2008	42	31	16	11	*
January 11-14, 2008	36	32	15	16	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	(VOL.) DK/ Refused
November 2-5, 2007	27	37	16	19	1
October 19-22, 2007	25	34	20	21	*
August 10-13, 2007	28	36	18	18	*
Mid-November, 2006	31	40	17	11	1
December, 2005	35	35	18	11	1
Early November, 2005	35	39	17	9	*
Mid-May, 2005	30	39	19	11	1
January, 2005	35	41	17	7	*
Mid-October, 2004	30	43	16	10	1
Early September, 2004	39	34	15	11	1
Mid-January, 2004	37	41	15	7	*
December, 2003	35	38	14	11	2
November, 2003	40	34	15	10	1
October, 2003	32	39	16	12	1
September, 2003	39	30	18	12	1
March, 2003	40	35	16	8	1
February, 2003	42	33	15	10	*
December, 2002	38	34	17	10	1
February, 2002	35	40	15	9	1
January, 2002	30	44	16	9	1
December, 2001	37	40	13	8	2
Mid-November, 2001	41	36	15	7	1
June, 2001	24	41	18	16	1
May, 2001	34	36	15	15	0
April, 2001	36	34	16	13	1
February, 2001	30	39	18	12	1
January, 2001	32	38	17	11	2
June, 1995	26	41	22	11	*
March, 1995	27	45	19	9	*
February, 1995	23	41	22	13	1
December, 1994	28	43	20	9	*
October, 1994	27	40	20	12	1
June, 1994	25	42	23	10	*
May, 1994	33	40	16	10	1
January, 1994	34	39	16	10	1
Early January, 1994	36	44	13	7	*
December, 1993	35	41	15	8	1
October, 1993	33	38	20	9	*
September, 1993	37	40	14	8	1
Early September, 1993	39	39	14	9	*
August, 1993	41	36	14	9	*
May, 1993	37	38	18	6	1
February, 1993	49	36	10	5	*
January, 1993	42	39	12	7	*
September, 1992	43	37	13	6	1
May, 1992	39	39	15	6	1
March, 1992	47	38	11	4	*
February, 1992	47	37	10	6	*
January, 1992	44	40	11	5	*
October, 1991	36	38	16	9	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	(VOL.) DK/ Refused
b. A major oil leak in the Gulf of Mexico					
June 3-6, 2010	57	27	9	6	*
May 27-30, 2010	55	26	11	7	*
May 20-23, 2010: *An oil leak in the Gulf of Mexico threatening the coast of several states*	47	35	11	7	*
May 13-16, 2010	58	29	9	4	*
May 7-10, 2010	46	33	11	10	*
April 30-May 3, 2010: *Oil leaking into the ocean near the Louisiana coast after an off-shore oil rig explosion*	44	35	11	10	*
April 23-26, 2010: *An explosion on an off-shore oil rig near the coast of Louisiana*	21	35	22	23	*
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
April 1-5, 2010: *President Obama's proposal to allow offshore oil and gas drilling*	20	24	21	33	1
July 25-28, 2008: *A major oil spill into the Mississippi River*	14	19	25	41	1
December 4-8, 2002: *The large oil spill polluting the coast of Spain*	15	29	28	27	1
May 4-7, 1989: *The Alaska oil spill*	52	37	7	4	--
c. Israel intercepting boats carrying supplies to Gaza, killing nine aboard					
June 3-6, 2010	22	26	17	33	1
TREND FOR COMPARISON:					
March 19-22, 2010: *Reports about tensions in the Middle East between Israelis and Palestinians*	15	28	27	30	1
June 19-22, 2009: *The situation between Israelis and Palestinians*	15	26	30	29	1
January 23-26, 2009: *Conflict between the Israeli military and Hamas forces in Gaza*	31	31	18	20	*
January 16-19, 2009	24	31	22	22	1
January 9-12, 2009	34	35	18	13	0
January 2-4, 2009	28	32	22	18	*
March 7-10, 2008: *Continued violence in the Middle East between the Palestinians and the Israelis*	20	33	26	21	*
August, 2006: *The military conflict between Israel and Hezbollah forces in Lebanon*	40	34	14	10	2
September, 2003: *Continued violence in the Middle East between the Palestinians and the Israelis*	31	36	20	13	*
July, 2003	26	40	20	13	1
December, 2002	29	36	22	12	1
Early October, 2002	32	39	20	8	1
June, 2002	38	33	18	10	1
April, 2002	38	37	14	10	1
Early April, 2002	44	33	13	9	1
December, 2001	31	40	19	9	1

PEW.1 CONTINUED…

	Very closely	Fairly closely	Not too closely	Not at all closely	(VOL.) DK/ Refused
April, 2001: *Continued violence in the Middle East*	22	34	24	19	1
Mid-October, 2000: *Continued violence in the Middle East between the Palestinians and the Israelis*	30	38	18	13	1
Early October, 2000: *Renewed violence in the Middle East between the Palestinians and the Israelis*	21	30	27	21	1
January, 1997: *Renewed tensions between Israelis and Palestinians over Hebron*	12	23	29	35	1
January, 1993: *Israel's expulsion of 400 Moslem fundamentalists following the murder of an Israeli soldier in the West Bank*	10	25	31	33	1
June, 1990: *The incident in Gaza in which a deranged Israeli killed seven Palestinians and the West Bank riots that followed*	11	28	30	30	1
May, 1988: *The conflict in the Middle East between the Palestinians and the Israelis in the occupied territories*	18	37	34	9	2
d. The NHL Stanley Cup finals					
June 3-6, 2010	7	9	11	72	1
TRENDS FOR COMPARISON:					
October 30-November 2, 2009: *The Major League Baseball World Series*[1]	16	16	18	49	*
October 24-27, 2008	12	12	18	58	*
October 26-29, 2007	20	16	20	43	1
November, 1989	23	17	22	38	*
October, 1988	31	21	19	28	1
June 5-8, 2009: *The NBA Finals*	13	9	12	67	*
June 20-23, 2008: *The Boston Celtics winning the NBA Finals*	18	17	22	42	1
e. Reports that the White House discussed the possibility of administration jobs with Democratic Senate candidates to get them to not run against its preferred candidates					
June 3-6, 2010	13	17	18	50	2
f. Former Vice President Al Gore and his wife Tipper announcing that they are separating after 40 years of marriage					
June 3-6, 2010	7	16	25	50	2

[1] October 24-27, 2008 and October 26-29, 2007 asked about "The Major League Baseball Playoffs and World Series." November 1989 and October 1988 asked about "The World Series."

ASK ALL:

PEW.2 Which ONE of the stories I just mentioned have you followed most closely, or is there another story you've been following MORE closely? [**DO NOT READ LIST. ACCEPT ONLY ONE RESPONSE.]**

June 3-6 2010	
66	A major oil leak in the Gulf of Mexico
9	Reports about the condition of the U.S. economy
4	Israel intercepting boats carrying supplies to Gaza, killing nine aboard
4	The NHL Stanley Cup finals
1	Former Vice President Al Gore and his wife Tipper announcing that they are separating after 40 years of marriage
1	Reports that the White House discussed the possibility of administration jobs with Democratic Senate candidates to get them to not run against its preferred candidates
6	Some other story **(VOL.)**
8	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

QUESTIONS PEW.3 AND PEW.4 PREVIOUSLY RELEASED

ASK ALL:

PEW.5 Thinking about the oil leak in the Gulf of Mexico, we would like to know how interested you are in some aspects of the news coverage. First, are you very interested, somewhat interested, not too interested or not at all interested in **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]**. Next **[INSERT NEXT ITEM]**. **[REPEAT RESPONSE CATEGORIES AS NECESSARY]**

		Very interested	Somewhat interested	Not too interested	Not at all interested	**(VOL.)** Don't know
a.	The impact on the people and economy of the Gulf Coast					
	June 3-6, 2010	69	22	5	4	1
b.	The impact on the environment and wildlife in the Gulf					
	June 3-6, 2010	74	19	3	3	*
c.	Projections of how far the oil will spread					
	June 3-6, 2010	71	19	4	5	1
d.	The methods being used to try to stop the oil leak					
	June 3-6, 2010	66	22	4	4	3
e.	Questions about who is to blame and how they should be held accountable					
	June 3-6, 2010	51	27	11	8	2
f.	How elected officials in Washington are responding to the oil leak					
	June 3-6, 2010	54	28	7	8	3

ASK ALL:

PEW.6 How much do you trust information about the Gulf Coast oil leak that comes from **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]:** A lot, some, not too much or none at all?

		A lot	Some	Not too much	Not at all	**(VOL.)** Don't know
a.	BP **[IF NECESSARY:** The oil company]					
	June 3-6, 2010	8	31	29	28	4
b.	The federal government					
	June 3-6, 2010	12	39	25	21	2
c.	News organizations covering the oil leak					
	June 3-6, 2010	20	47	20	11	2

PEW.7-PEW.10 PREVIOUSLY RELEASED